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Impactful and Ethical Uses of AI

The discussion of the use of artificial intelligence is very controversial when it comes to the idea of its use within the workspace. My current major at Charleston Southern is in Computer Science. Within the major itself, the application and development of AI is an essential topic to discuss. Computer scientists have a wide range of career opportunities, such as becoming data scientists, software engineers, IT administrators, etc. An important aspect of this career field is using technology to improve the lives of many people in an ethical fashion. One code of conduct associated with Computer Science is that one should not use computers and technology with the intent to cause harm to another individual. This code of conduct highlights the importance of users' privacy and security in a rapidly advancing digital age.

The influence of Artificial Intelligence is complex as it can be used as a helpful tool to achieve tasks while also creating ethical dilemmas, especially in the workplace. It is evident that the improvement of AI models is creating issues revolving around user privacy and data safety. B.J Copeland, a professor of Philosophy at the University of Canterbury, New Zealand, states the following about the use of AI, "Privacy is another aspect of AI that concerns experts. As AI often involves collecting and processing large amounts of data, there is the risk that this data will be accessed by the wrong people or organizations". B.J Copeland argues that sensitive information can go floating around the internet and through AI models, which creates a security risk for

users. When information is fed into an AI model, the AI will take that information, process the information then learn from the information it has received from the user. This can cause an ethical dilemma due to the AI remembering what a user has prompted it, and it will feed that information to other people or organizations for use. This is a problem, especially for technology companies that handle huge amounts of code. If a company decides to use AI to help its progression through its business, there is a risk that the code or sources they feed the AI to help them go through the AI and be accessed by other organizations or people.

To ensure ethical integrity within the career fields of computer science, individuals can use a process to help identify and solve the challenges of the ethical integrity of AI. Clarifying the problem would be the first step. There are many ethical issues related to AI, including data protection, AI replacing jobs and AI potentially being biased in the data it generates. Gathering information about these problems, such as facts and stakeholders, is the next important step. Asking who is at risk and what valuable information can be lost are good questions to consider in the process. Next is applying guiding principles, and identifying consequences and virtues associated with ethical dilemmas. These factors could include but not be limited to losing valuable data due to AI spreading information it was fed by a user, and potentially spreading misinformation or biased information given by AI. Then individuals can act based on the consequences, coming up with solutions to help prevent the issues in the future. Lastly, individuals should reflect on the process, take further consideration of their actions, and learn what they can do better next time.

Different worldviews and societies reflecting on the topic of AI are also important to discuss as it can lead to opening several different opinions and beliefs others may have that an individual has not thought of. Within the Christian worldview, I would say that they are very

cautious and skeptical about the use of AI, but they do believe it can be of good help if it is utilized correctly. In the bible, God says to the Israelites, “You shall have no other God's before me” (NKJV Exodus 20:3). In this quote, God highlights the importance of resisting idolatry and fake Gods. We can use this idea and relate it to the use of AI by researching information provided to us by AI to ensure what it has given to us is true. We need to always be wary of what AI provides to us. In the scripture of Matthew 12:7, Jesus says to his disciples, “Therefore, whatever you want men to do to you, do also to them, for this is the Law and the Prophets”, (NKJV Matthew 12:7). The golden rule should apply to everyone, even if an individual is not Christian. We as people should not advocate for the harm of others, thus we should treat others the way we would like to be treated. On the contrary, there is also the professional society's say in the ethical dilemmas. Professional society accepts the use of AI and advocates for its use to be fair. The professional society may not be as skeptical of the use as much as Christians due to their nature of heavily using AI and their familiarity with it. Their use of AI, especially in the field of computer science, is high due to the nature of it being fast and efficient for performing minor tasks. The Christian viewpoint of AI is weary, but the professional viewpoint of AI sees it as a useful tool. Both viewpoints can be compatible with each other as they both address the good and bad that come with the use of AI. I believe that Christians would be the ones to dive further into the moral and ethical parts of its use due to their nature.

AI's use in the realm of computer science fields can be very beneficial to a workplace while also serving ethical dilemmas alongside it. AI can open more doors of opportunity for us as a society, but it takes issue with users' privacy, security, and liability. Applying a code of ethics can help minimize these issues when using AI to our aid. The Christian and Professional views on AI offer both similarities and differences, with Christians being more skeptical of ethical

dilemmas while Professionals emphasize its use for efficiency in the workspace. Altogether, these perspectives on AI call attention to the need to integrate ethics to ensure the fairness and security of those who use it.

Works Cited

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